Kaelin Brightspark

CHARACTER NAME

Bard (College of Lore) 4 CLASS & LEVEL	**Human** ANCESTRY
Entertainer BACKGROUND	**Neala** PLAYER
she/her PRONOUNS	**Chaotic Good** ALIGNMENT

STR -1 (8)

DEX +2 (14)

CON +1 (12)

INT +1 (12)

WIS +0 (10)

CHA +4 (18)

ARMOR CLASS 10

HIT POINTS 27 / 27

SPEED 30 ft

PROF. BONUS +2

ABILITIES & PROFICIENCIES

- AC: base 10; 13 while wearing leather armor
- Initiative +3; saving throws: Dexterity +4, Charisma +6
- Expertise: Performance +8, Persuasion +8
- Lore proficiencies: Arcana +3, History +3, Insight +2
- Jack of All Trades: +1 to non-proficient ability checks
- Bardic Inspiration d6: 4 uses per long rest; bonus action, 60 ft
- Song of Rest d6: allies spending Hit Dice regain +1d6 HP
- Cutting Words: reaction, spend Inspiration to reduce a foe's roll

EQUIPMENT & WEALTH

- Leather armor
- Rapier, dagger, and belt knife
- Well-worn lute carved with vines and leaves
- Musician's pack

PURSE 875 gp

ATTACKS, SPELLS & FEATURES

- Spellcasting: Charisma; save DC 14; spell attack +6
- Slots: 1st 4, 2nd 3; spells known 7; cantrips known 3

CANTRIPS

- Vicious Mockery (action, 60 ft): Wis save; 1d4 psychic damage and disadvantage on its next attack before your next turn
- Minor Illusion (action, 30 ft, 1 min): create a sound or a still image no larger than a 5-ft cube; physical contact reveals it
- Message (action, 120 ft, 1 round): whisper to one creature you point at; it may whisper a reply only you hear

1ST-LEVEL SPELLS

- Detect Magic (action/ritual, self, concentration 10 min): sense magic within 30 ft; an action reveals a visible aura's school
- Faerie Fire (action, 60 ft, concentration 1 min): creatures in a 20-ft cube make Dex saves; failures glow, cannot hide by invisibility, and attacks against them have advantage
- Healing Word (bonus action, 60 ft): one creature regains 1d4 + 4 HP; cannot cast another leveled spell that turn
- Dissonant Whispers (action, 60 ft): Wis save; 3d6 psychic and target uses its reaction to flee; half damage and no movement on success

2ND-LEVEL SPELLS

- Calm Emotions (action, 60 ft, concentration 1 min): Cha saves in a 20-ft-radius sphere; suppress charm/fear or make targets temporarily indifferent
- Detect Thoughts (action, self, concentration 1 min): read nearby surface thoughts; probing deeper allows a Wis save and reveals your intrusion
- Invisibility (action, touch, concentration 1 hr): target and carried gear become unseen until it attacks or casts a spell

WEAPON ATTACKS

- Attacks: rapier +4 (1d8+2 piercing); dagger +4 (1d4+2 piercing)

PHYSICAL DESCRIPTION

Slender and striking, with wild red curls, bright hazel eyes, freckles, and a mischievous grin. Her clothes are a riot of emerald and deep gold patches. A well-worn lute carved with vines and leaves rests across her back.

CURRENT STATE

Mood: Bright, watchful beneath the brightness

Disposition: Fiercely attached to the party, though she frames it as casual

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THE PERSON BEHIND THE NUMBERS

VALUES & DRIVES

- Joy as resistance: laughter and music are deliberate acts of defiance.
- Carry hope for people who cannot carry it themselves.
- Treat every person as a story whose course can still be changed.
- Protect the people she loves, whatever the performance may suggest.

FEARS & WOUNDS

- The burning inn and the friends who died after her careless insult.
- That her own words may cause harm again.
- The silence in which old loss becomes audible.

VOICE & MANNER

- Vibrant, quick, and infectious; she naturally fills a room.
- Frames danger and combat as stories with endings that can be changed.
- A sharp observer beneath the performance.
- Moves from bawdy tune to heartbreaking ballad without warning.

LOYALTIES

- The party, whom she privately regards as her second chance.
- The memory of the friends who died; her music carries their names.
- Her irreplaceable lute and the life of wandering it represents.

INTERNAL CONTRADICTION

Kaelin presents herself as someone who has never been hurt. Her wrist tattoos, guarded care around powerful people, and fierce protectiveness tell a different story to anyone paying attention.

SIGNIFICANT DETAIL

Her vine-carved lute has survived everything with her. It is not merely an instrument and cannot be replaced.

OPEN THREADS

- The tyrannical noble who burned the inn
- The friends killed in that fire
- The strange verse that entered The Fey Glade without her choosing

NOTES FROM THE ROAD